

CONTROLLED UNCLASSIFIED INFORMATION

Justification and Approval (J&A) for Other Than Full and Open Competition

Was a J&A approved for the preceding acquisition where that acquisition required a J&A? ☐ Yes ☒ No

Is this a new or amended J&A Document? ☒ New ☐ Amended (Prior to Award Only!)

Is this a Bridge Action as defined at DAFFARS 5302.101? ☐ Yes ☒ No

Dollar Value of this Acquisition: ☒ ≤ \$750K ☐ > \$750K and ≤ \$15M ☐ > \$15M and ≤ \$100M ☐ > \$100M

Contracting Activity: PZ (Arnold) OL Holloman

Purchase Request (if available) / Local ID Number: F2ETG46043A101

Program / Project (and PE, if applicable): 80-Ton Rough Terrain Crane

Program Type (PEO, Enterprise, of Operational): Operational

Authority:
6.302-1 – 10 USC 3204(a)(1), Only One Responsible Source - No Other Supplies or Services Will Satisfy Agency Requirements

Estimated Contract Cost (including options): \$ 524,935.00 **J&A Type:** ☐ Class ☒ Individual

COORDINATION (DAFFARS 5306.304(a))

[Sign and Save Procedure](#)

** The text in the signature blocks below is editable, including the title.

** To remove a row, click the "X" next to the signature block. **CAUTION:** Once removed, it can only be restored by downloading the BLANK FORM again.

Date 11 Mar 2026	Project Lead / Program Mgr / Requiring Activity Heather J. Morris 704 TSS/TGSO / 575-572-0203	Signature MORRIS.HEATHER.JENE.1247036616 Digitally signed by MORRIS.HEATHER.JENE.1247036616 Date: 2026.03.11 09:55:06 -06'00'	X
Date 11 Mar 2026	Contracting Officer Tyler S. Payne AFTC/PZI / 340-6372	Signature PAYNE.TYLER.S.1376784750 Digitally signed by PAYNE.TYLER.S.1376784750 Date: 2026.03.11 12:33:59 -05'00'	X
Date	Communications and Info Systems Officer (CSO) [Name] [Office Symbol / Phone Number]	Signature	X
Date	Local Legal Reviewer [Name] [Office Symbol / Phone Number]	Signature	X
Date	Chief of the Contracting Office (COCO) [Name] [Office Symbol / Phone Number]	Signature	X
Date	Competition Advocate [Name] [Office Symbol / Phone Number]	Signature	X
Date	Senior Contracting Official (SCO) [Name] [Office Symbol / Phone Number]	Signature	X

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Date	PEO / Commander (Requirements Cognizance) [Name] [Office Symbol / Phone Number]	Signature	X
Date	Deputy Assistant Secretary (Contracting) [Name] [Office Symbol / Phone Number]	Signature	X
Date	[Title] [Name] [Office Symbol / Phone Number]	Signature	X
Date	[Title] [Name] [Office Symbol / Phone Number]	Signature	X

APPROVAL ([DAFFARS 5306.304\(a\)](#))

Date	Chief of the Contracting Office (COCO) [Official Signature Block]	Signature
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I. Agency and Contracting Activity.

The contracting organization responsible for the proposed contract action is the Air Force Test Center (AFTC), Directorate of Contracting, Installation Contracting Division, AFTC/PZI (Holloman), 872 DeZonia Drive, Holloman AFB, NM. The requiring activity is the AFTC of which the 704th Test Group (704 TG) is a member.

II. Nature and/or description of the action being approved.

This Justification supports the sole source acquisition of one used 2019 Grove GRT880 80-Ton rough terrain crane, Serial Number 236124, from MGX Equipment Services, Inc. The estimated value of the acquisition is \$524,935.00. This acquisition is for a specific commercial product currently located on-site and in use by the requiring activity.

III. Description of supplies/services required to meet agency needs.

The 704th Test Group, Detachment 1 (704 TG, Det 1), requires one (1) 80-ton capacity rough terrain crane to support daily test operations. The specific requirement is for the used 2019 Grove GRT880, Serial Number 234124, which has been leased from MGX Equipment Services, Inc. and operated by the requiring activity since 2019. The crane supports movement and positioning of large test targets, mounting and dismounting operations, and securing assets during weather events. The requiring activity has determined that continued access to a second operational crane is necessary to sustain mission operations.

IV. Demonstration that the contractor's unique qualifications or the nature of the acquisition requires use of the authority cited above.

MGX Equipment Services is the only source capable of providing the specific used 2019 Grove GRT880 rough terrain crane, Serial Number 236124, currently located on-site and in operational use by 704 TG, Det 1.

The requiring activity must maintain a minimum of two operational cranes to execute its test missions. The subject crane is currently on-site under a rental agreement that limits its availability to the specific customer mission for which it was rented. If the Government does not acquire this specific asset, the crane would be returned and the unit would be left with only one operational crane during the time required to identify, procure, transport, inspect, and place a replacement asset into service. The take approximately 9 to 12 months, creating an unacceptable capability gap and significantly degrading mission support.

A detailed rent-versus-buy analysis provides clear financial justification for this acquisition, demonstrating that purchasing is the most fiscally responsible option. The analysis shows that continuing to rent a crane of this type incurs an estimated annual cost of \$258,000, based on a typical monthly rate of \$21,500. In stark contrast, the total annual cost of ownership -- including depreciation (\$52,493), annual maintenance (\$26,247), inspections, and miscellaneous expenses -- is estimated to be only \$92,240. Crucially, the break even analysis reveals that purchasing the asset becomes more cost-effective than renting if the crane is needed for more than 4.3 months per year. Given that this crane is a mission-critical asset required for year-round test support, its utilization will far exceed this threshold, making the purchase overwhelmingly the more economical choice and converting a perpetual rental liability into a long-term government asset.

The Government's need is not merely for any crane of similar general type, but for continued access to this specific on-site asset. Acquisition of Serial Number 236124 avoids transition delay, eliminates transportation and mobilization costs associated with obtaining another asset and preserves.

V. Description of efforts made to ensure that offers are solicited from as many potential sources as practicable, including whether a notice was or will be publicized as required by subpart 5.2 and, if not, which exception under FAR 5.202 applies.

Market research was conducted to establish price reasonableness. This research confirmed that while other cranes are available on the market from vendors such as American State Equipment and Cleveland Crane & Shovel Sales, no other source can provide this specific asset that is already in the 704 TG, Det 1's possession. Therefore, no other source can meet the Government's requirement to avoid the unacceptable delays and costs detailed above.

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VI. Determination by the Contracting Officer that the anticipated cost to the Government will be fair and reasonable.

The purchase price of \$524,935.00 was evaluated against historical pricing, current market prices for comparable used Grove RT cranes, and the cost of a new replacement asset. In addition, the requiring activity conducted a rent-versus-buy analysis indicating continued rental would cost approximately \$258,000.00 annually based on a monthly rate of \$21,500.00. Estimated annual ownership costs, including depreciation and maintenance, are approximately \$92,240.00. The analysis indicates the purchase becomes more economical than continued rental if the crane is required more than 4.3 months annually. Because the crane supports year-round test operations, the purchase represent the most economical solution.

VII. Description of the market research conducted and the results, or a statement of the reasons market research was not conducted.

Market research was conducted in January 2026 with data from MGX Equipment Services, American State Equipment, Cleveland Crane & Shovel Sales, and the 441st Vehicle Support Chain Operations Squadron (VSCOS). The research analyzed pricing for new and comparable used Grove RT cranes. This research supports the conclusion that the price for the 2019 model is well-positioned within the market and represents good value for the Government.

VIII. Any other facts supporting the use of Other Than Full and Open Competition.

The subject asset is already integrated into the daily operations of the 704th Test Group, Detachment 1. The unit requires a minimum of two operational cranes to execute its test mission. Acquisition of the specific crane currently on site allows the Government to maintain uninterrupted mission capability while avoiding the delays associated with identifying, procuring, transporting, and integrating a replacement asset.

Additionally, the requiring activity has extensive operational and maintenance familiarity with this crane, including its performance history and reliability within the Radar Target Scatter (RATSCAT) Advanced Measurement Systems (RAMS) environment. Acquiring the existing asset avoids the technical and performance risks associated with introducing an unfamiliar platform that may require additional evaluation, maintenance adjustments, or operational modification.

Finally, acquisition of this on-site asset eliminates transportation and mobilization costs that would otherwise be required to deliver a comparable crane to the test facility.

IX. List of any sources that expressed, in writing, an interest in the acquisition.

A Notice of Intent to award on a sole source basis was posted to the Governmentwide point of entry (SAM.gov) in accordance with FAR Part 5. As the date of this justification, no other sources have submitted written capability statements expressing interest in provide the required asset.

Any responses received prior to the close of the notice period will be reviewed and evaluated to determine whether they demonstrate the capability to meet the Government's requirement.

X. A statement of the actions, if any, the agency may take to remove or overcome any barriers to competition before any subsequent acquisitions for the supplies or services required.

This justification is specific to this unique opportunity. Any future requirements for new or replacement cranes will be procured using full and open competition, unless a similar circumstance provides a clear benefit to the Government that can be justified in accordance with the FAR.

XI. Certification by the Contracting Officer.

As evidenced by my signature above, I certify that this justification is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief.

Justification and Approval (J&A) *for* Other Than Full and Open Competition

XII. Certification by the technical/requirements personnel.

As evidenced by my (our) signature(s) above, I (we) certify that any supporting data contained herein, which is my (our) responsibility, is both accurate and complete.

☒ Remove the Guidance pages below.